



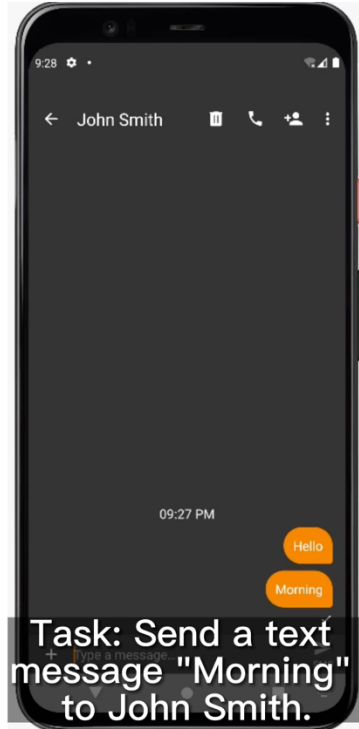
Elastic On-Device LLM Service

Wangsong Yin¹, Rongjie Yi², Daliang Xu², Gang Huang¹, Mengwei Xu², Xuanzhe Liu¹

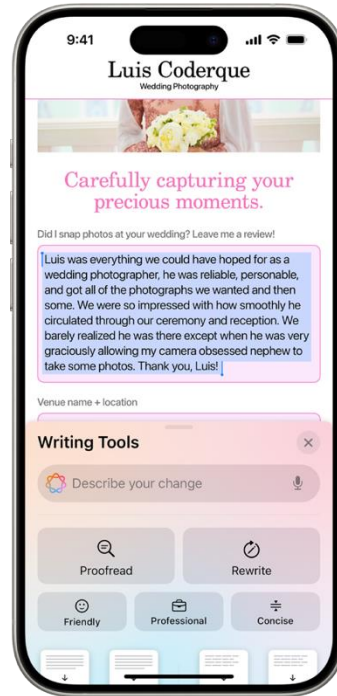
¹Peking University, ²Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications

ACM MobiCom 2025

On-Device Large Language Models



Automatic GUI
Manipulation



Screen
Comprehension

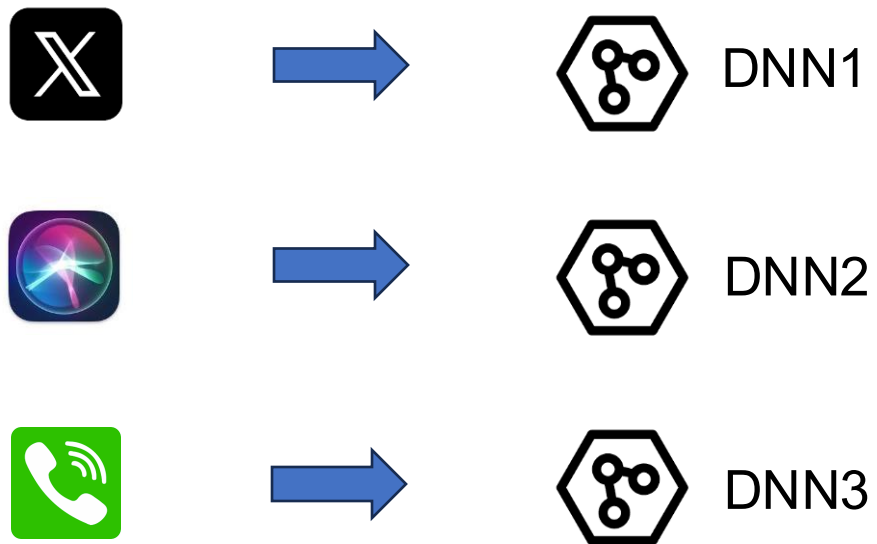


Voice
Assistant

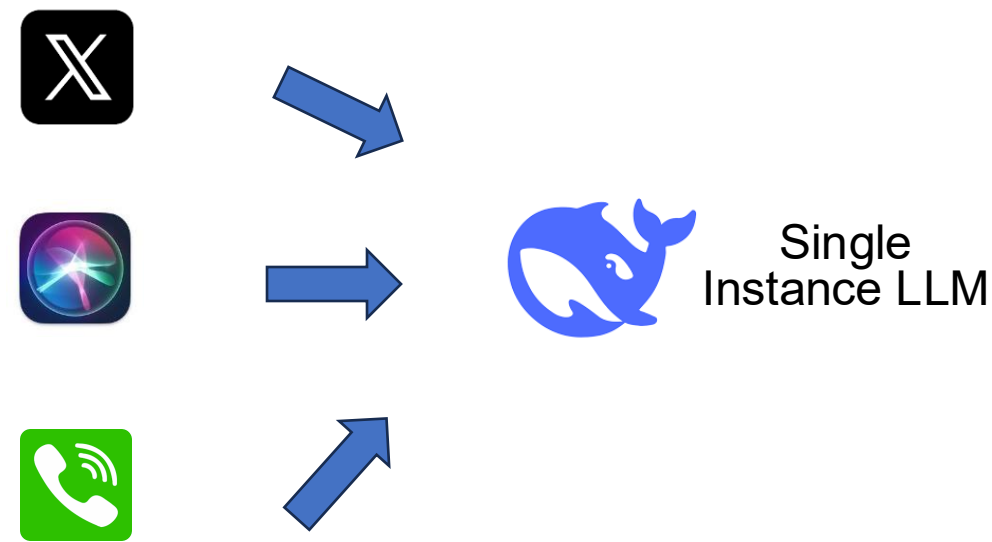
Privacy Sensitive!

**Needs On-Device
Deploying LLMs!**

A Paradigm Shift



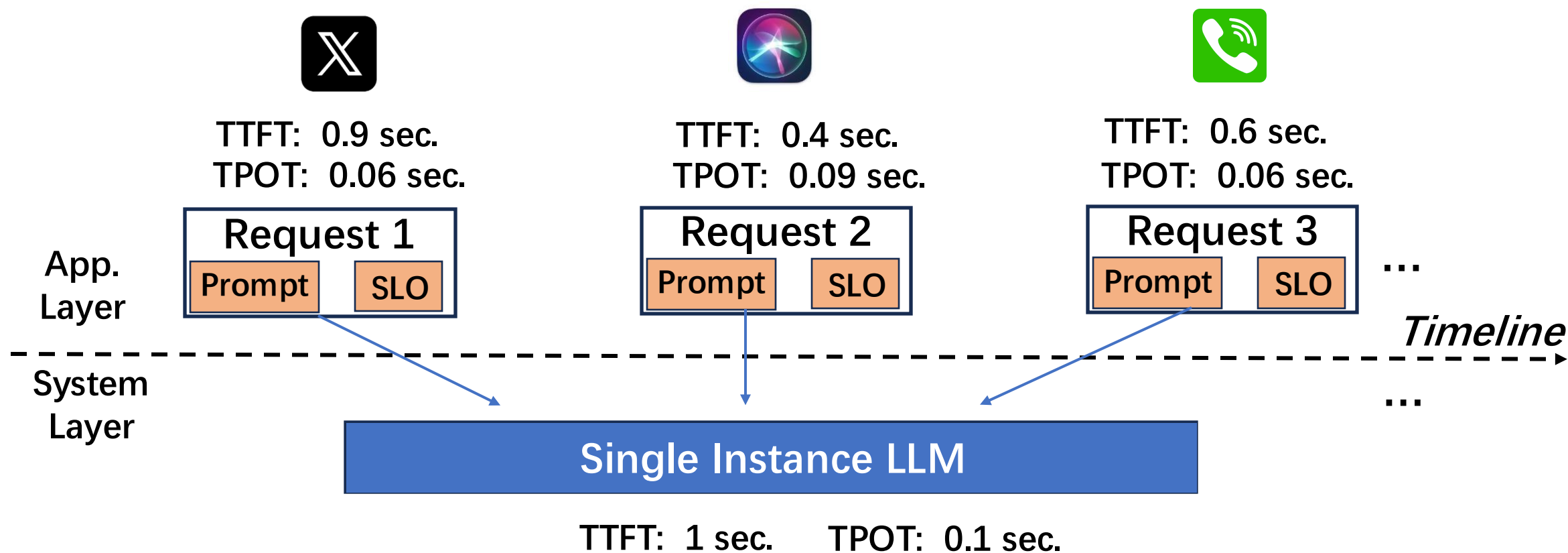
Previous: task-specific DNNs



Now: single-instance LLM service



The Problem



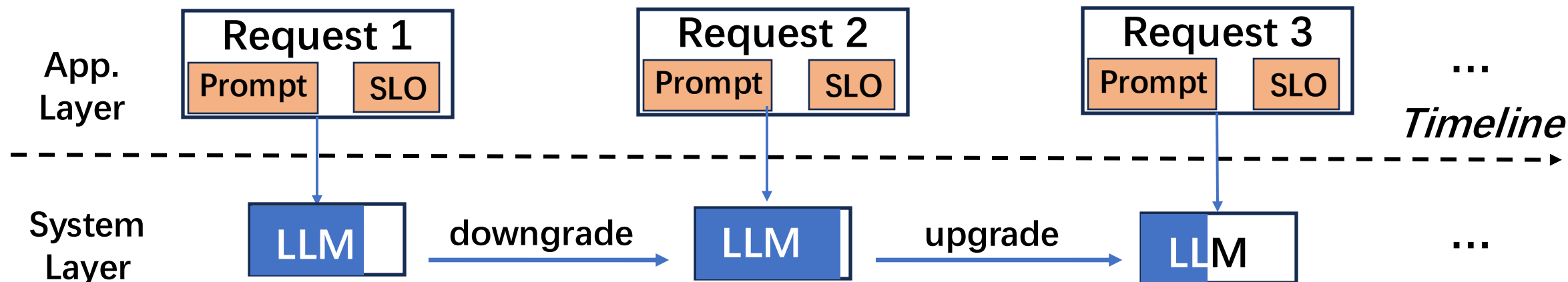
TTFT: Time-To-First-Token

TPOT: Time-Per-Output-Token

SLO: <TTFT, TPOT>

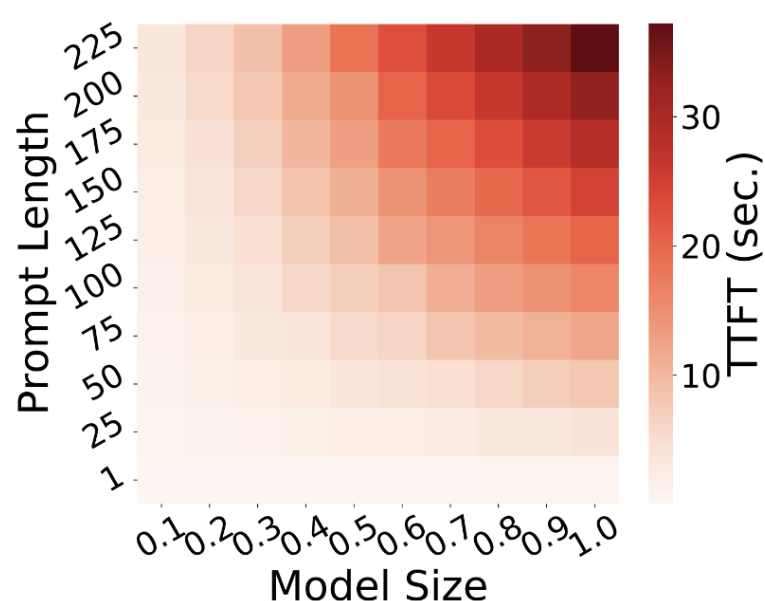
How to serve requests with **various SLOs** by a single LLM?

Our System

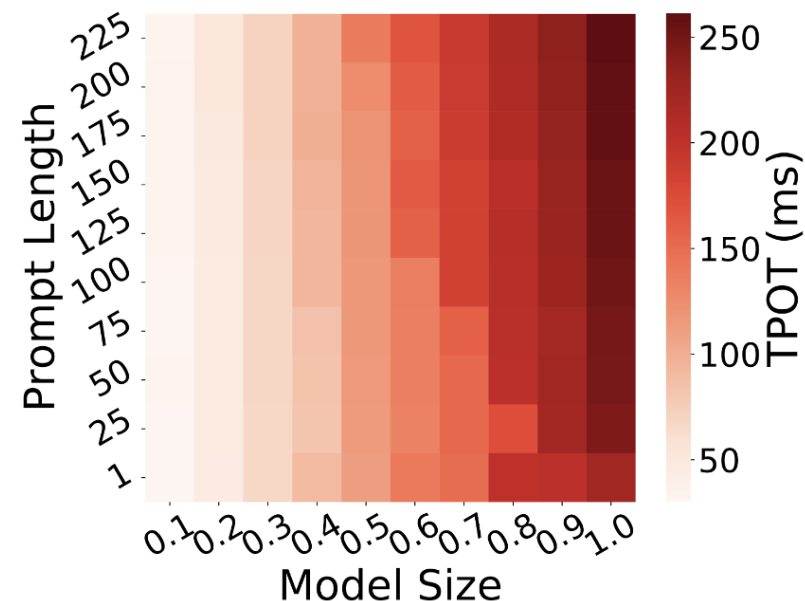


We present ElastiLM, a *runtime elastic* on-device LLM service.

Problem Analysis



(1) Prefill Latency

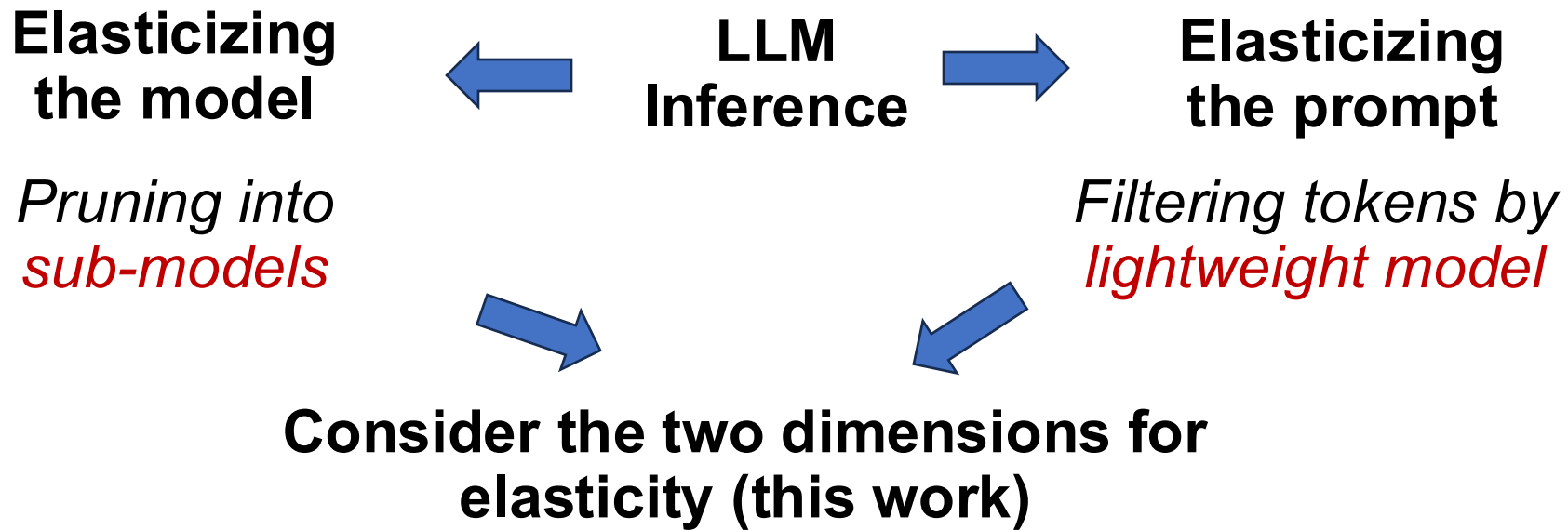


(2) Decode Latency

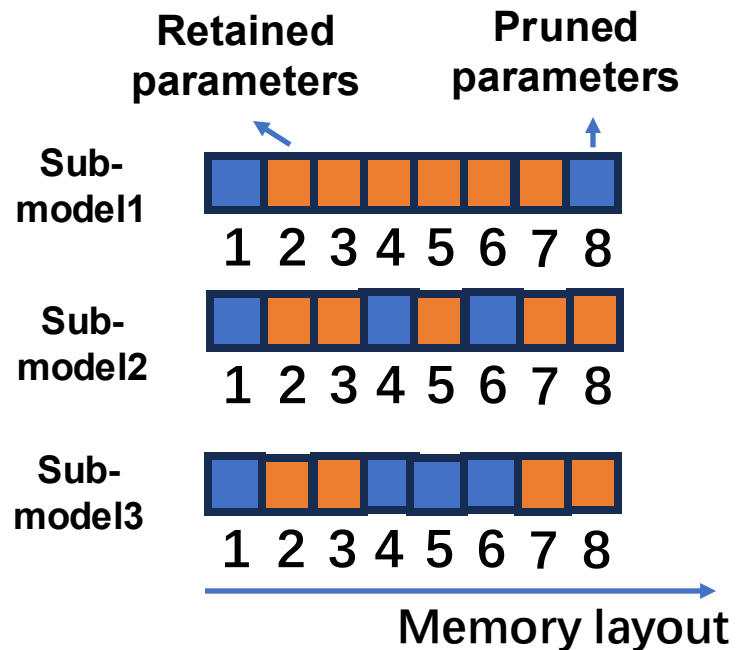
LLM inference latency w.r.t. prompt length and model size.
Measured on LLaMA-7B, Redmi K60 Champion (Snapdragon 8Gen2).

**The LLM inference latency is jointly impacted
by **model size** and **prompt length**.**

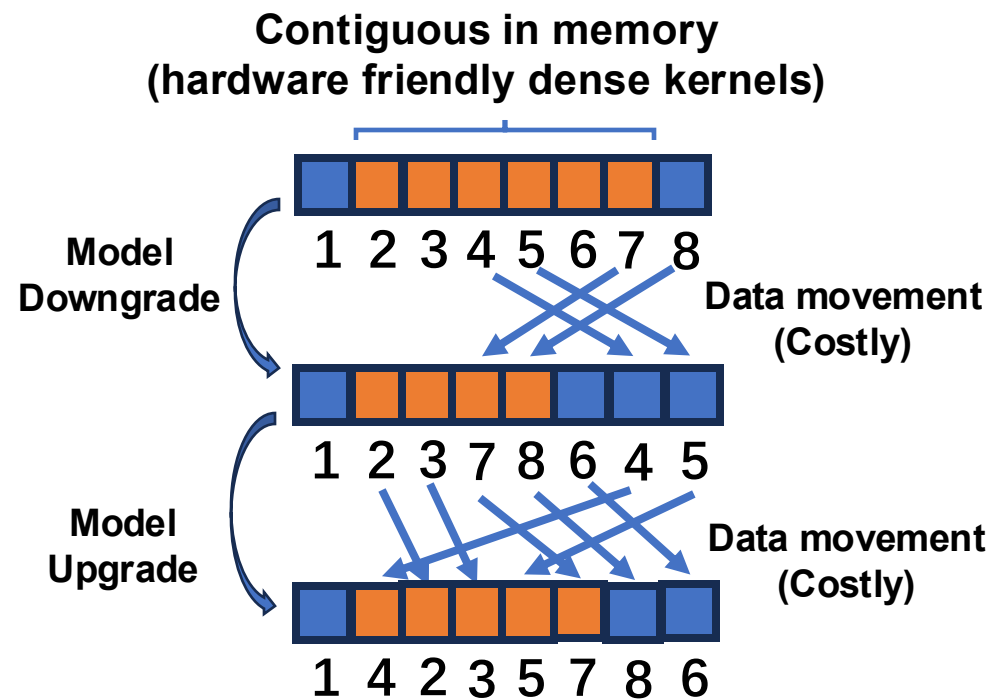
Problem Analysis



Challenge#1



(1) Sub-models.

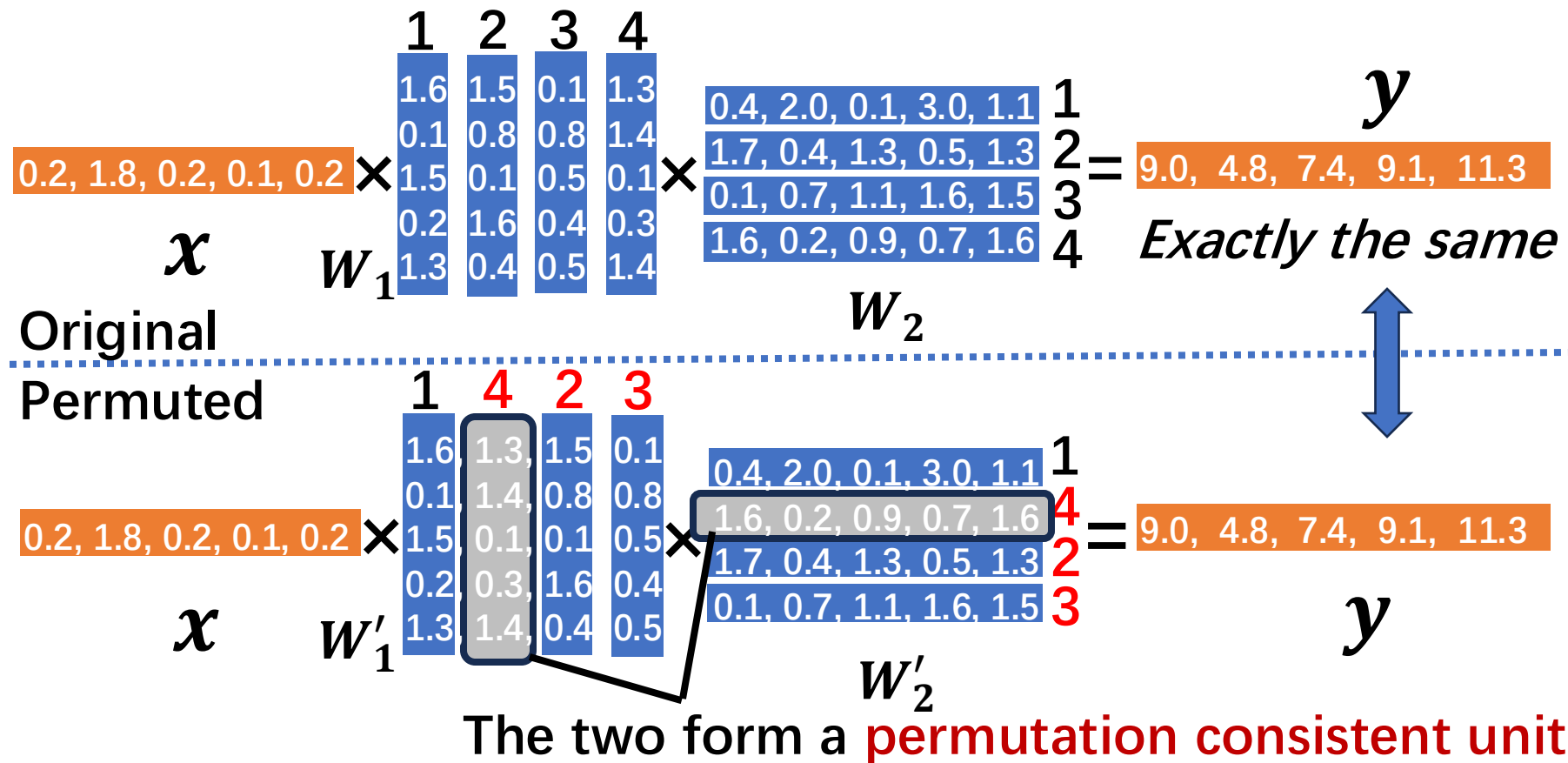


(2) Model upgrade/downgrade.

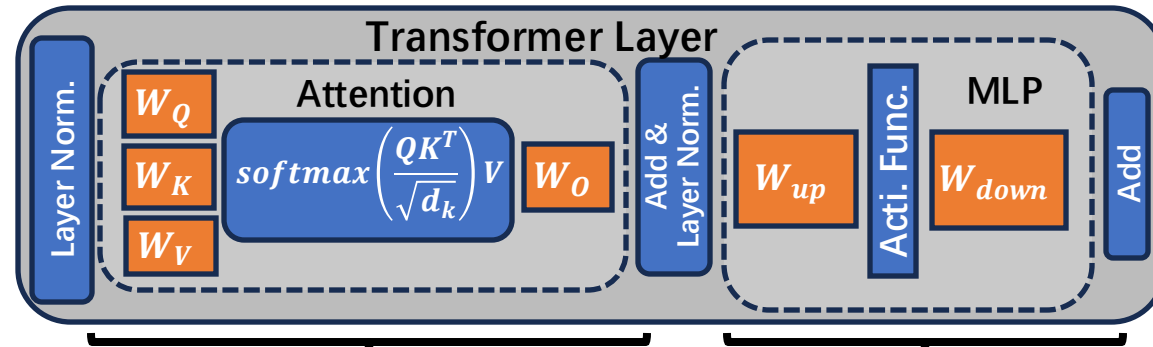
Movement of LLaMA-7B's a W_Q matrix (4096×4096) takes 139 ms on Redmi K60 Champion smartphone in the worst case.

The switching of sub-models can be costly.

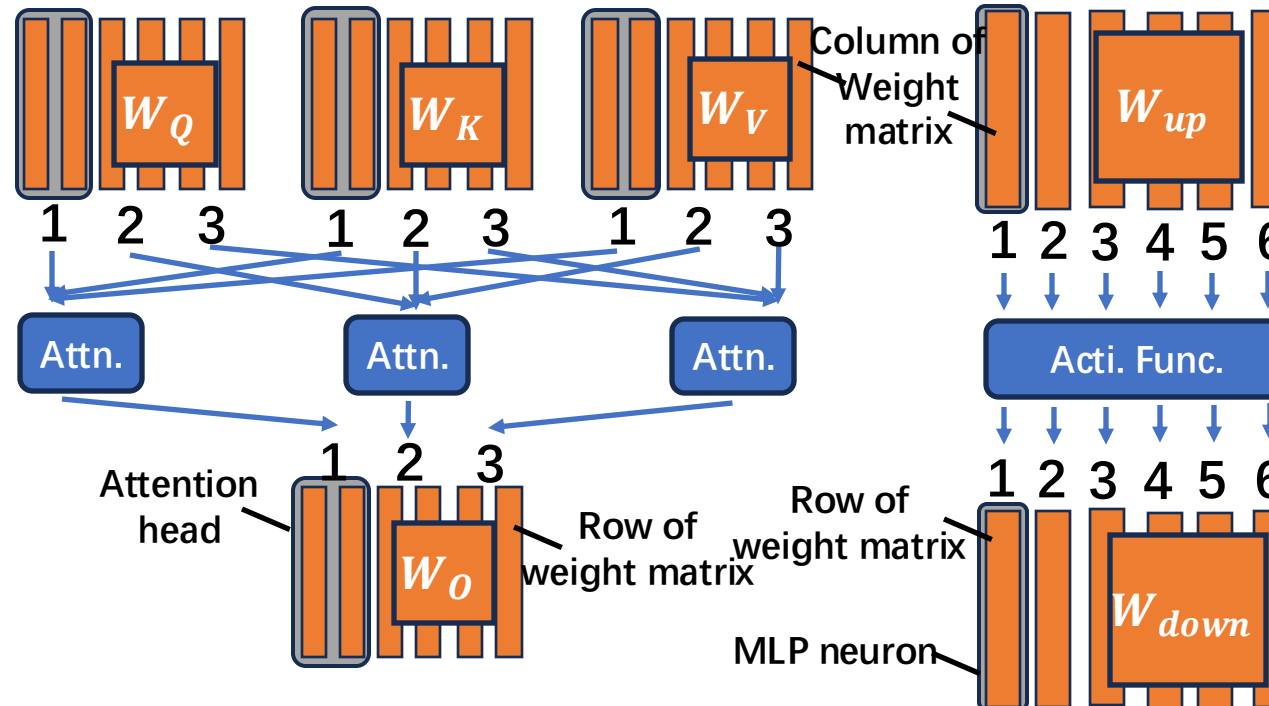
Insight: the permutation consistency



Insight: the permutation consistency

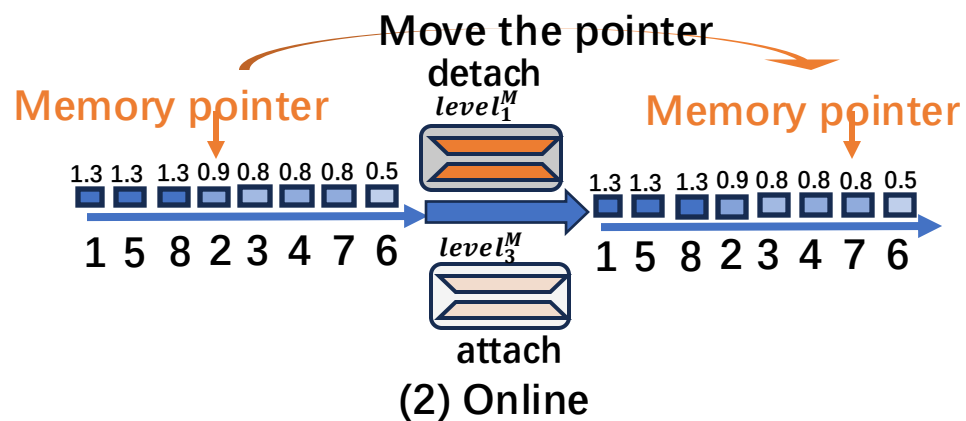
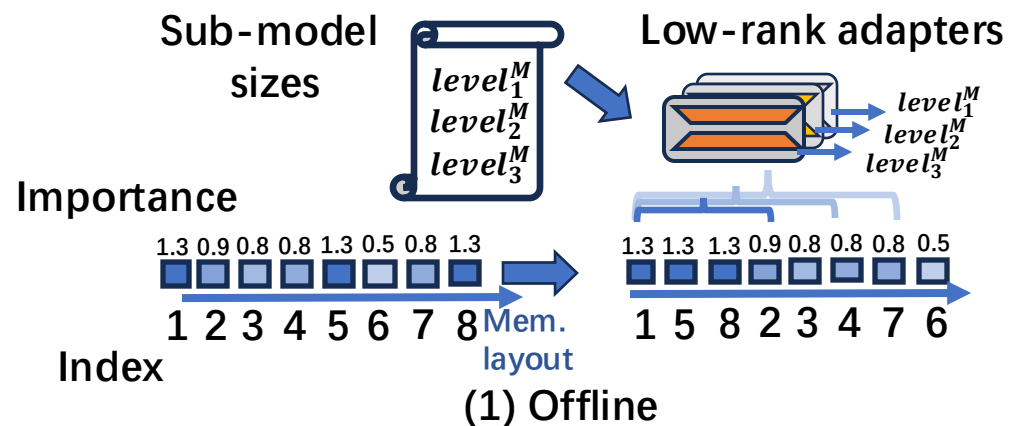


Each *head* is a permutation consistent unit.



Each *neuron* is a permutation consistent unit.

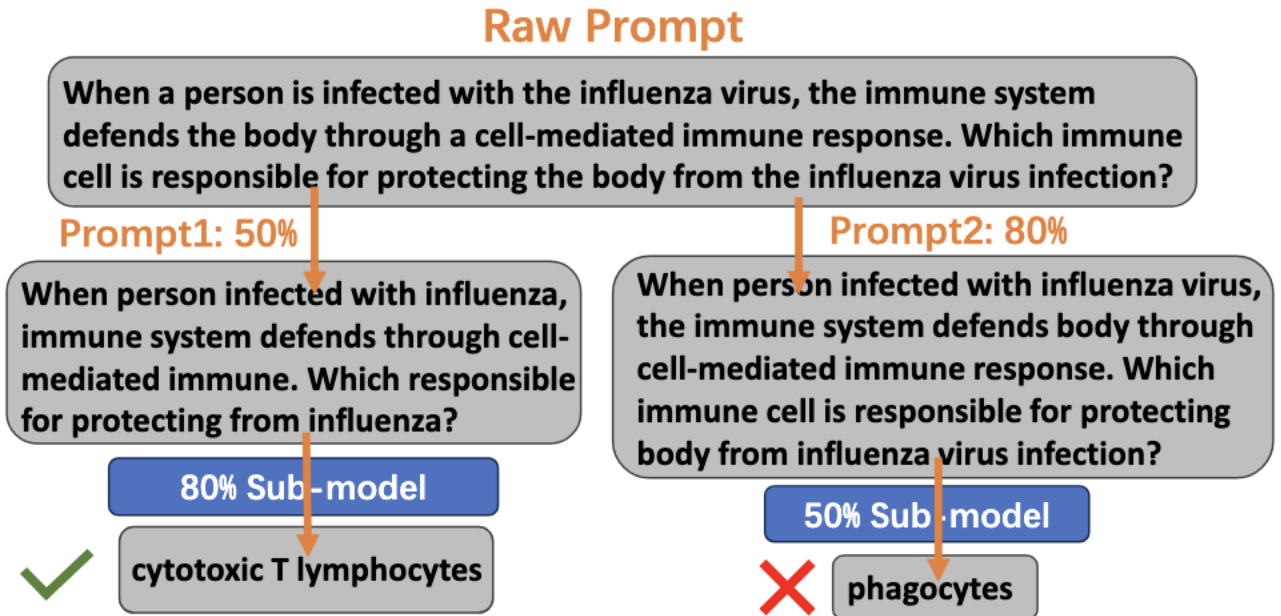
Design of Model Elastification



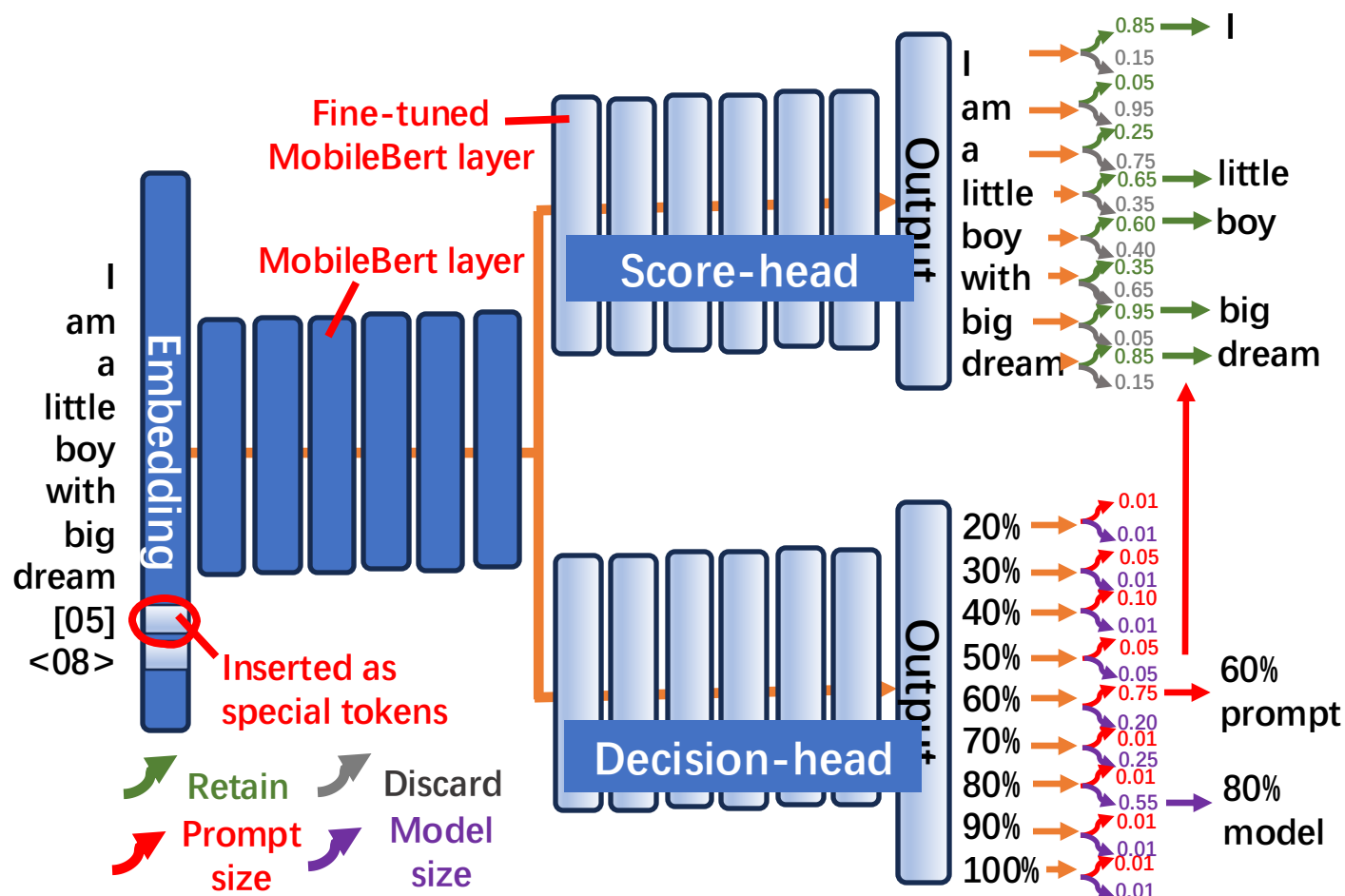
- One-shot unit-reordering
- Profiling unit importance through explainable AI
- Task-agnostic low-rank recovery of sub-models

Challenge#2

The prompt elastification and model elastification need careful orchestration.



Design of Prompt Elastification

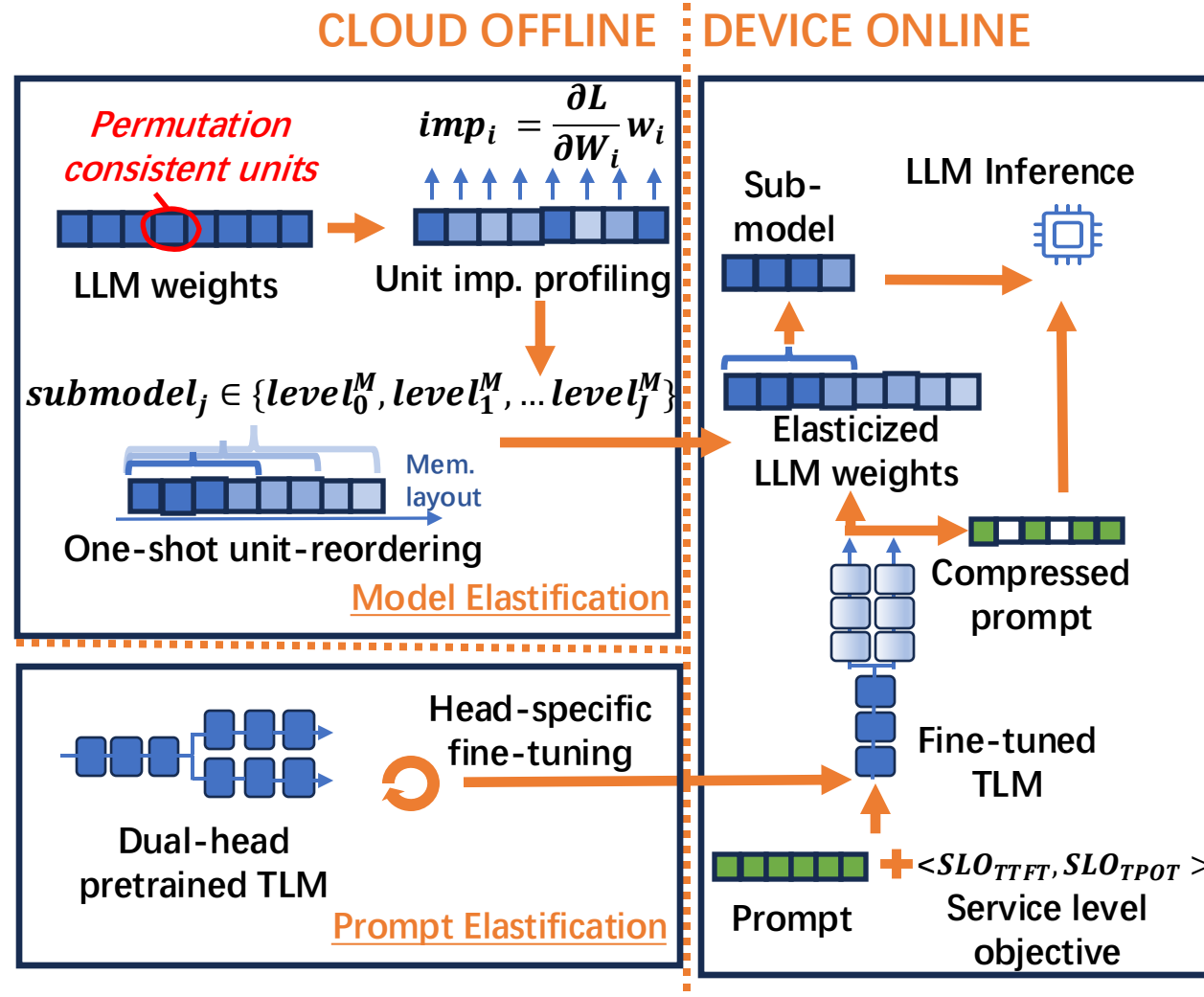


- Dual head tiny language model for prompt elastification and prompt-model orchestration
- Self-induced labelling process for decision-head training



Please refer to our paper for technique details!

Overall Workflow



Implementation and Evaluation Setup

■ *System Implementation*

- **Based on open source framework mllm**
- **Replacing Linear operator by ElasticLinear**
 - Adding extra memory pointer on top of the original dense kernel
- **Optimizing the low-rank add and multiplication by ARM NEON**

■ *Test Platform*

- **Cloud Server**
 - 64-core CPU (750GB RAM) and 8 A40 GPUs (45GB HBM each)
- **Smartphones**
 - Redmi K60 Champion (Snapdragon 8Gen2), MI14 (8Gen3), K70 Pro (8Gen3)

Implementation and Evaluation Setup

■ *Models*

- **Base model**
 - LLaMA-7B
 - Llama3-8B
 - Orca-mini-3B
- **Instruction following model**
 - Vicuna-V1.5-7B
 - Llama3-instruct-8B

■ *Datasets*

- **ARC_E**
 - Scientific QA and knowledge reasoning
- **OBQA**
 - Common sense reasoning
- **Octopus**
 - System API calling
- **LlamaTouch**
 - UI Automation
- **E2E synthesized traces**

■ *SLOs*

- *Random set 6 levels of SLOS, based on stepwise sensitivity hierarchy.*

Apps	SLO	Dataset
Rewind	<100%, 100%>	OBQA
GMail	<80%, 90%>	ARC_E
Octopus	<60%, 80%>	Octopus

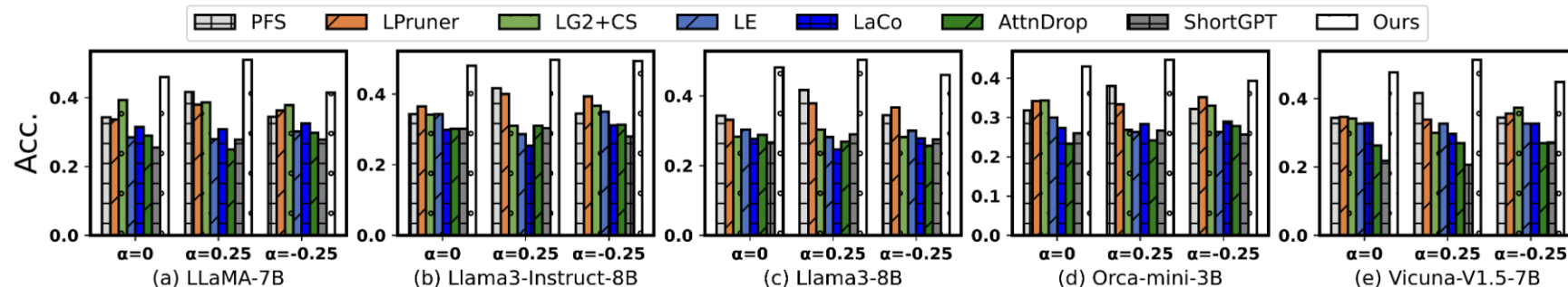
Apps	SLO	Dataset
Shortcuts	<40%, 70%>	LTouch
Gboard	<20%, 60%>	OBQA
XiaoAi	<20%, 50%>	ARC_E

Implementation and Evaluation Setup

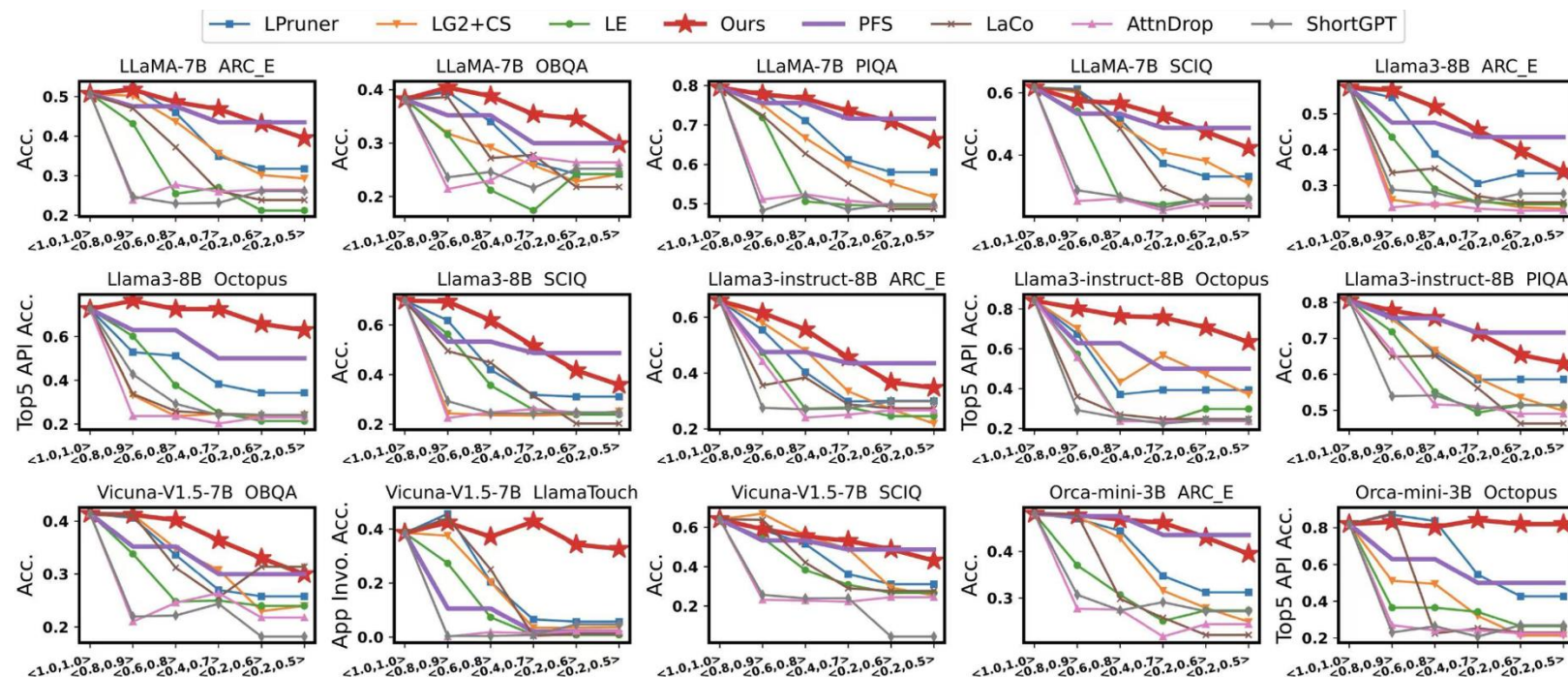
■ **Baselines**

- **Pretraining from scratch (PFS)**
 - Directly using off-the-shelf pretrained models with various sizes (The OPT family)
- **LLMPruner (LPruner)**
 - State-of-the-art parameter pruning method for model elastification
- **Layerwise Elastification (LE)**
 - Pruning in a granularity of a layer
- **LLMLingua2 + Contextual Sparsity (LG2+CS)**
 - Compress the prompt text at prefill stage, dynamically activate the neurons at decode stage
- **LaCo/ShortGPT/AttnDop**
 - Other fine-grained model elastification methods

Evaluation Results



End-to-end request response accuracy on the traces.

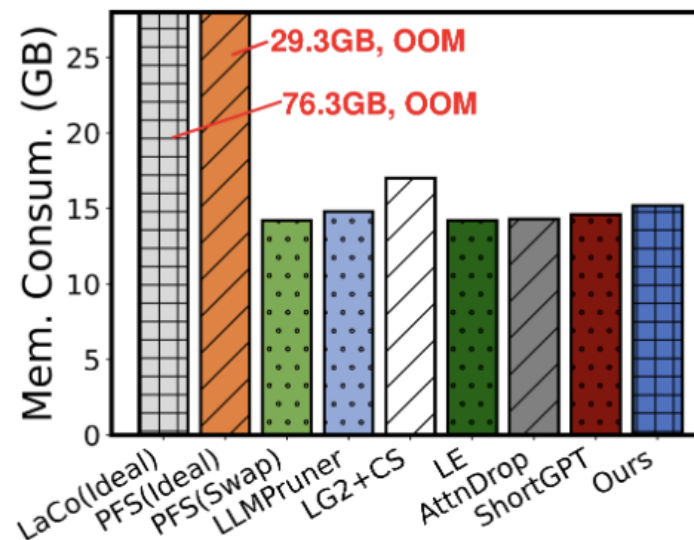


Performance under one SLO on an entire standalone dataset.

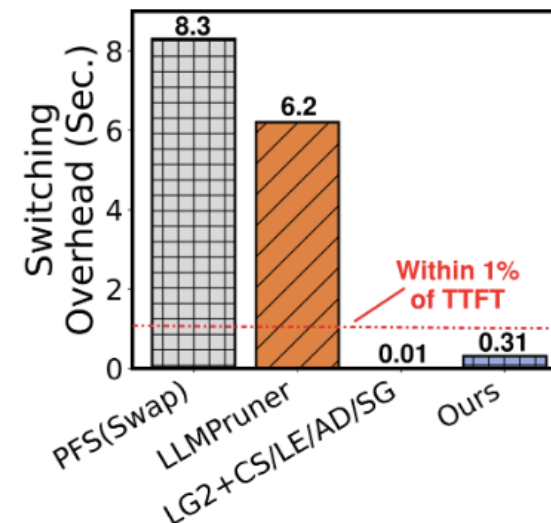
With meeting all SLOs, on end-to-end traces, our system achieves up to 16.83%, on average 11.04% absolute accuracy improvement; our system also achieves up to 34% and on average 22% absolute accuracy improvement on standalone datasets.

Evaluation Results

Compared to baselines, our system **does not introduce obvious extra memory consumption**; the switching overhead between various models is **within 1% of TTFT**.



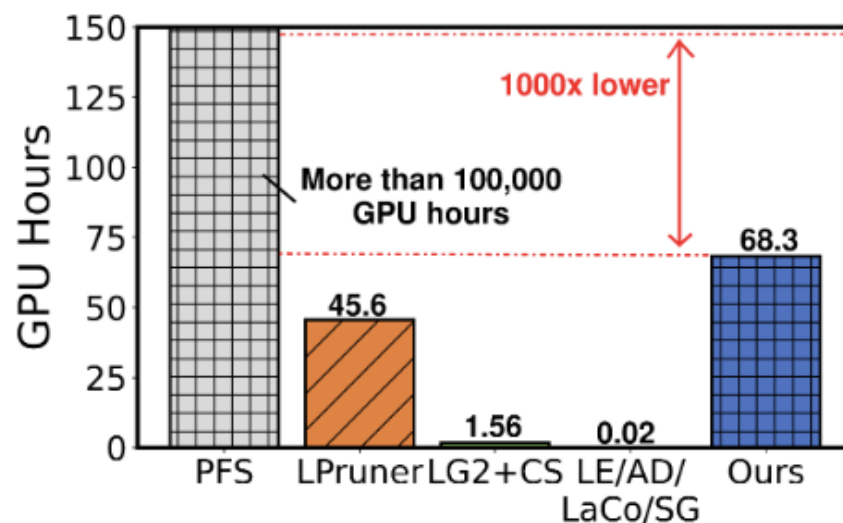
(1) Memory consumption



(2) Switching time

Evaluation Results

The offline overhead of elastification is only **68.3 GPU hours** (cost about **100 dollars** for cloud GPU renting), being affordable for most of developers.



Corpus Source	# of Tokens	GPU Hours
Bookcorpus	6.4K	0.03
Alpaca-cleaned	50M	40.4
Meetingbank	50M	1.7
MMLU-Pro	340K	26.3

Take Aways

- We present ElastiLM, an **elastic** on-device LLM service for serving requests with **various SLOs**.
- ElastiLM innovatively elasticizes a single LLM through both the **model dimension** and the **prompt dimension**.
- ElastiLM significantly outperforms competitive baselines by **up to 14.83% and 10.45% on average** in accuracy.

Code: <https://github.com/yinwangsong/ElastiLM>



yws@stu.pku.edu.cn